

Q.2b (20 marks): Briefly describe the factors responsible for decline in marriage and anthropological interpreta...



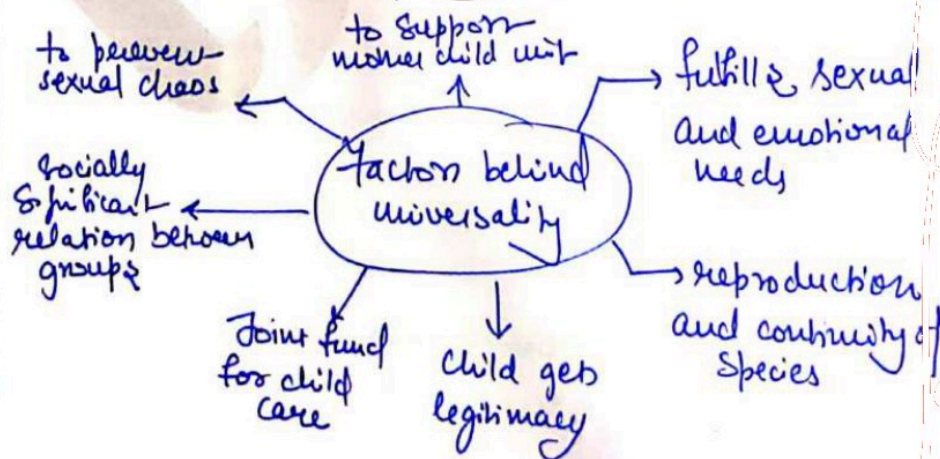
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- 2.b) Briefly describe the factors responsible for decline in marriage in the world and also give Anthropological interpretations of live-in relationships.
(20 marks)

Marriage as defined by Kathleen Gough after her study on Nayers is the union between a woman and one or more partners where the child born to the woman, as prescribed according to rules of relationship, is accorded full birth status rights as of his/her social status.

Background -

Marriage is known since Paleolithic times as concluded by Leakey et al. It has existed across space and time.



Decline in marriage

Marriage definitely fulfills needs of individual and society however

- ↳ it restrict individual freedom
- ↳ In majority of world, it is patriarchal and leads to subjugation of women
- ↳ It regulates sexual instincts and other self seeking impulses
- ↳ Has less focus on male female emotional compatibility
- ↳ Divorce is tabooed in several societies
- ↳ Exchange of bridewealth and dowry adds to economic pressure on kind groups

Thus, there has been rise in alternative solutions like

- ↳ Live in relationships in metropolitan cities
- ↳ Dhunka marriage in tribes of Jharkhand where couples can't afford marriage so live

together ~~just~~ without social status and legal protection

→ Sologamy to promote self love
e.g. first incident in Vadodra, websites like Imagyne.com

→ Contract or sham marriages just for the sake of green card for migration or housing space in congested urban areas

→ Same sex relationships after decriminalisation of Sec. 377 by Supreme court

→ Single parent households or Single women adopting orphan children

With modern ideas of freedom, dignity, individualism, rights by constitution, the control of kinship on marriage seems to be reducing

Anthropologically div in relationships can be viewed as -

Anthropological Interpretations of marriage

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Threat to marriage

→ As per post modernists - our social institutions in themselves are not stable and so is marriage which faces a threat now.

Not a viable alternative to marriage

→ Interpreting as per Levi Strauss' Alliance theory, live in does not lead to alliances between kin groups and hence cannot replace the vital structure of marriage

→ As per structural functionalists, marriage and its rules, its associated customs integrate society and ensure continuity of social structure

→ As per symbolic theorists, we can say that marriage is symbolic of statuses of kin groups involved that isn't so in live-in.

However, live-in is seen in recent times as not actually replacing but becoming a precursor to marriage for the purpose of finding a perfect companion for life and is hence actually strengthening it.